

1. Don't classify. Hallucinate!

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-14T21:54:35+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/14/dont-classify-hallucinate/>

Don't classify. Hallucinate! I still have quite a bit of older content on my blog that I never got round to tagging. My blog has 1,856 tags - likely too many to feed to an LLM in one go and say "which of these tags match the following content". Doug Turnbull has a neat solution. Tell the model to output tags without any details of the existing vocabulary, then use vector embeddings against the existing corpus to find the concrete tags that are closest to the ones the model imagined might fit! His example prompt suggests including an example of the shape of your tags to help the model make a more useful guess: Your task is to create novel, never seen before, furniture, home goods, or hardware classification that best fit a search query. Product classifications might look like: Furniture / Living Room Furniture / Coffee Tables & End Tables / Coffee Tables DØcor & Pillows / Decorative Pillows & Blankets / Throw Pillows Furniture / Bedroom Furniture / Dressers & Chests Kitchen & Tabletop / Kitchen Organization / Food Storage & Canisters School Furniture and Supplies / School Furniture / School Chairs & Seating / Stackable Chairs Baby & Kids / Toddler & Kids Bedroom Furniture / Kids Be...

2. alchemy-utils 0.1a1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-13T03:03:17+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/13/alchemy-utils/>

Release: alchemy-utils 0.1a1 Performance boost for DuckDB exports and CSV imports, see here .

3. There are no lossless transformations of natural-language text

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-11T23:48:35+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/11/there-are-no-lossless-transformations-of-natural-language-text/>

There are no lossless transformations of natural-language text Sophie Alpert shares her "internal policy on acceptable use of AI writing by engineers". It's a short read (supporting its own recommendations) and really good. If you chose to have LLMs help massage your writing the following rule seems crucial to me: You must stand behind every idea and every sentence in your docs . It is your responsibility to make sure that the entire document is representative of your own thoughts before you share it. If a reviewer asks, "What did you mean by this line?", it's not acceptable to reply with "Oh sorry, AI wrote that, just ignore it." You will confuse your readers (and waste their time) if you present them things that are not genuinely representative of your thoughts. The "no lossless transformations" idea from the post title is expanded on here: There are no lossless transformations of natural-language text ? every rewrite and rephrase changes the meaning of your writing, and if this is done by an entity that doesn't have the most detailed mental representation of what you personally were trying to communicate, information will be lost. Tags: writing , ai , generative-ai , llms , ai-...

4. ? You Don't Need to Worry About Scratching Your iPhone Camera Lenses

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-14T17:16:15Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/08/iphone_camera_lens_scratch_resistance

The exposed lens covers are made of sapphire, not glass, and are thus incredibly scratch resistant. And even if, somehow, do you pick up a scratch on a lens cover, it almost certainly won't affect image quality at all.

5. Google's ?Material 3? Design Write-Up Is 93.3 Percent Embarrassing

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-14T16:33:55Z

Link: <https://design.google/library/expressive-material-design-google-research>

This page from Google Design on their "Material 3" UI language came to my attention after my snarky post about the ungainly new to-do app they bizarrely bragged about on Twitter/X this

week. I don't think this 'Material 3' page is new ? I think it's a few years old ? but I'd never seen it before. First, it's crazy that (in desktop browsers with a mouse cursor) they change the I-beam cursor for text selection to ... a circle. I guess it looks kind of fun but the whole point of the I-beam cursor is to enable precise character selection. They changed that to something that makes precise selection as difficult as possible. It'd be better to just use an arrow pointer than to replace the I-beam with a goddamn circle. This, from the UI design team. Second, this paragraph made me honestly wonder if I was reading a spoof, a years-old unfunny April Fool's 'prank'. But as far as I can tell this is totally straight, not a prank: These factors can be quantified in users' responses to new M3 Expressive designs. We found a 32% increase in subculture perception, which indicates that expressive design makes a brand feel more relevant and 'in-the-know.' We also saw a 34% boost in modernity, making...

6. Google's Pixel Watch 5

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-12T19:38:03Z

Link: <https://www.theverge.com/tech/978094/pixel-watch-5-hands-on-made-by-google-gemini-wearables-smartwatch>

Victoria Song, The Verge: The \$399 Google Pixel Watch 5 isn't about the hardware. Sure, there's a new satin pyrite case finish, a few new strap colors, and a Steph Curry Special Edition. Under the hood, there's a slightly faster Qualcomm processor and an itty-bitty battery bump. There's a \$50 price hike from last year, too, because the Pixel Watch 5 isn't immune to RAMageddon ? none of us are. Otherwise, no one would blame you for looking at this watch and thinking absolutely nothing's changed. That's because the big updates this year are all software-based. I have never seen anyone in real life wearing a Pixel Watch. (I've only seen a handful of people using Pixel phones, and every single one of them was at a tech event of some sort.) You can also use AI to generate watchfaces. I created a watchface featuring 'fat cats and an elegant font.' It didn't quite do that. The fat cats weren't characters, so much as pleasantly plump, cat-shaped clock numbers. It's a gimmicky way to shoehorn the Nano Banana model onto the watch? but if that's your thing, it works. Well I'm sure now I'll see plenty of people wearing Pixel Watches. ?

7. Forcing an ARM64X executable to run as a specific architecture

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260814-00/?p=112613>

You can request the target machine architecture. The post Forcing an ARM64X executable to run as a specific architecture appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. A little helper class for managing LPPROC_THREAD_ATTRIBUTE_LISTs

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 13 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260813-00/?p=112611>

Another RAII-style wrapper. The post A little helper class for managing LPPROC_THREAD_ATTRIBUTE_LIST s appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Who's Tracking You? Use This New Service to Find Out

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 11:24:35 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/08/whos-tracking-you-use-this-new-service-to-find-out/>

It can be daunting to determine who's responsible for showing ads on the websites we visit, or who's harvesting data from the mobile apps we use every day. That information is already semi-public, but it is not easily parsed and traditionally much of it has remained walled away in the hands of large advertising platforms. Not anymore: A powerful and free new service called DecryptAds scrapes and correlates this adtech data and makes it simple to quickly learn a great deal about the entities that are tracking you.

10. Printing Lists

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-08-14T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/08/14/printing-lists.html>

To print a comma-separated list, a concise idiom is to optionally print the comma first, before the element:

11. Edinburgh Fringe: Target Audience ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 18:45:41 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-target-audience/>

Easily the best show I've seen at the Fringe. For plot-related reasons, a television company asks a literary genius to create a "pro-weapons sitcom". It is a fast paced mix of the sitcoms 2012 and Episodes. The jokes come at a steady pace - some attack with the furiousity of bullets, others the the subtlety of a knife in the night. All four of the cast are spectacular. Turning the?

12. Edinburgh Fringe: Stand-up Philosophy ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 15:16:26 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-stand-up-philosophy/>

For a pay-what-you-want show this was decent. Three comedians doing sets on the theme of philosophy - followed by a Q&A where the audience poses philosophical conundrums to them. It more-or-less works as a gimmick. Although an early afternoon crowd may have been more likely to ask questions anonymously. I've never seen a Sikh doing an unnervingly accurate impression of Trump before. Daman?

13. Edinburgh Fringe: Waiting for Wonka ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 12:31:07 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/edinburgh-fringe-waiting-for-wonka/>

This play is fucked up! Such a brilliant concept - what happened to the kids from Charlie and the Chocolate Factory after they were rejected by Wonka? Stuck together in a Big-Brotheresque household, they trauma-dump on each other. New Zealand's Half Trick have shrunk their full-length play into a Fringe-standard 60 minutes. That does make it a little brusque and, simultaneously, a bit?

14. How This Blog Is Built

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-08-14T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/08/14/how-this-blog-is-built.html>

It's Jekyll, hosted on GitHub Pages.

15. How Will the 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act Affect Housing Supply? Part II

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 12:03:37 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-will-the-21st-century-road-to>

This is the second installment of my look under the hood of the recently passed 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act, looking at what each provision actually does and trying to suss out its actual impact on housing supply.

16. Premium: How Much Money Does AI Need?

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 15:48:21 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-how-much-money-does-ai-need/>

I've heard from people in the past that my articles are too long, and I wanted to start by saying that, for the most part, they're going to stay long, because I feel like the only way for me to make my arguments is to be

17. Oh Hey, It's Not Just Me

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/its-not-just-me/>

My whole life I've felt like I have great eyesight (and I still do). But lately I've been noticing what feels like some slippage. Nothing big. Just this feeling in the morning like, as my brain and body wake up, my vision needs to as well. The strange novelty of this phenomenon

was operating in some small part of my subconscious the other day when I was scrolling the internet and come across this post from Chris Coyier : you ever get to your mid forties and have your eyesight drop off a friggin cliff And I?m all like: And then even more people weighed in on Chris? thread, like ?Hey me too!? This is why I love the web. I continually get that feeling of, ?Oh hey, it?s not just me!? On both a personal and a professional level. And for that I?m grateful. I love being able to connect with people in a way that makes me not feel so alone (or weird) in my experience of life. In a polarized digital world, it?s good to remember that the web can still draw you to folks rather than push them away. We?ve got a lot in common.

Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky

18. This Week on The Analog Antiquarian

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 16:05:50 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/08/this-week-on-the-analog-antiquarian/>

Richard Goes to the Movies

19. Pluralistic: Capital formation (14 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 14 Aug 2026 11:10:41 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/14/one-chokable-throat/>

Today's links Capital formation: Going legit means going mainstream. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: London Copyfighters x Speaker's Corner; TSA v lipstick; Long Beach v photographers; China x David Cameron's internet censorship; McMansion Hell; Copyrighting an MTG deck; "Privacy preserving age verification" delenda est. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Capital formation (permalink) Funny thing about competition: there's both a pro-market and an anti-market case for a competitive system. <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/13/one-chokable-throat/#too-clever-by-half> If your theory is that markets deliver prosperity by spurring businesses to provide the superior products and services at lower prices needed to attract and retain workers and customers, then competition is a must-have. Without competitors, companies are "too big to care": <https://pluralistic.net/2024/04/04/teach-me-how-to-shruggie/#kagi> Meanwhile, if you think that the pressure o...